

# **Citizens Face Delays in Government Service Approvals**

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**Subject : Design Thinking**

**Step:1**

## **Key observations**

- Citizens experience long waiting periods for certificates, licenses, and welfare approvals.
- Applicants frequently visit government offices for follow-ups.
- Online portals often face technical issues or slow processing.
- Lack of clear communication causes confusion and frustration.
- Delays result in dissatisfaction and stress among users.
- Citizens often need to make multiple office visits.
- Delays reduce public trust in government services.

## **User Identification**

**Step :2**

- **Primary Users – Citizens / Applicants:**  
Apply for government services and expect quick approvals, clear timelines, transparency, and fewer office visits.
- **Secondary Users – Government Office Staff:**  
Verify documents and process applications; need proper staffing, training, and reliable digital systems.
- **Tertiary Users – Department Administrators / Supervisors:**  
Oversee service delivery and ensure deadlines; need accurate reports, accountability, and coordination between departments.

1. Have you ever applied for any government service?
2. Which type of government service did you apply for?
3. Did you face delays in getting approval?
4. How long did the approval take?
5. What do you think is the main reason for delays?
6. How satisfied are you with the government service approval process?
7. What improvement do you suggest?

| Timestamp          | Have you ever applied for any government service? | Which type of government service did you apply for? | Did you face delays in getting approval? | How long did the approval take? | What do you think is the main reason for delays? | How satisfied are you with the government service? | What improvement do you suggest? |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1/23/2026 7:52:51  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Lack of staff                                    | Dissatisfied                                       | Better communication             |
| 1/23/2026 7:55:01  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | Less than 1 week                | Slow processing                                  | Very satisfied                                     | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:00:20  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Corruption                                       | Dissatisfied                                       | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:00:29  | No                                                | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Slow processing                                  | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:02:48  | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Corruption                                       | Satisfied                                          | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 8:05:06  | No                                                | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Corruption                                       | Neutral                                            | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 8:05:26  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Corruption                                       | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:07:53  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | No                                       | Less than 1 week                | Technical issues                                 | Satisfied                                          | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:08:01  | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Corruption                                       | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:09:14  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | No                                       | Less than 1 week                | Technical issues                                 | Very satisfied                                     | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 8:10:37  | No                                                | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:12:19  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | No                                       | 1–4 weeks                       | Corruption                                       | Neutral                                            | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 8:12:46  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | No                                       | Less than 1 week                | Technical issues                                 | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:23:20  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Corruption                                       | Dissatisfied                                       | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:35:31  | No                                                | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Satisfied                                          | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:40:08  | Yes                                               | Others                                              | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Slow processing                                  | Dissatisfied                                       | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:40:26  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Slow processing                                  | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:42:32  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Satisfied                                          | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:45:50  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Corruption                                       | Very dissatisfied                                  | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 8:47:47  | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Slow processing                                  | Dissatisfied                                       | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:51:54  | Yes                                               | License/Permit                                      | No                                       | 1–4 weeks                       | Corruption                                       | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 8:59:51  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Corruption                                       | Very dissatisfied                                  | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:00:55  | Yes                                               | License/Permit                                      | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Corruption                                       | Neutral                                            | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 9:03:41  | No                                                | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:12:28  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Corruption                                       | Dissatisfied                                       | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:13:16  | No                                                | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:20:28  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Dissatisfied                                       | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:24:14  | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Slow processing                                  | Very dissatisfied                                  | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:26:47  | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Slow processing                                  | Very dissatisfied                                  | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:34:05  | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | Less than 1 week                | Slow processing                                  | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 9:37:36  | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Corruption                                       | Neutral                                            | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 10:01:23 | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Slow processing                                  | Dissatisfied                                       | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 10:08:35 | No                                                | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | No                                       | Less than 1 week                | Lack of staff                                    | Neutral                                            | Strict timelines                 |
| 1/23/2026 11:08:19 | No                                                | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Slow processing                                  | Satisfied                                          | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 11:49:02 | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | More than 1 month               | Technical issues                                 | Dissatisfied                                       | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 13:29:11 | Yes                                               | ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)  | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Slow processing                                  | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/23/2026 15:59:55 | Yes                                               | Pension/Scholarship                                 | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Neutral                                            | Faster online processing         |
| 1/26/2026 16:20:44 | Yes                                               | Others                                              | Yes                                      | 1–4 weeks                       | Technical issues                                 | Neutral                                            | Strict timelines                 |

## Key Insights from Interviews

### Step :3

- Majority faced delays of **1–4 weeks or more than a month**.
- Common reasons: corruption, slow processing, technical issues, lack of staff.
- Many respondents were dissatisfied with the approval process.
- Most suggested faster online processing and strict timelines.

### Step:4

## **Pain- point Analysis**

Category    Pain Points

Functional Slow processing, repeated document verification

Emotional Stress, frustration, loss of trust

Systemic    Corruption, poor digital infrastructure, lack of accountability

### **Critical Pain Point:**

Unclear timelines and inefficient processing systems cause prolonged approval delays.

### **Step :5**

## **Root Cause Identification**

**Problem:** Long delays in government service approvals

1. Why are approvals delayed? → Because processing takes too long.
2. Why does processing take too long? → Due to manual work and technical issues.
3. Why is manual work still used? → Digital systems are unreliable or incomplete.
4. Why are digital systems unreliable? → Lack of proper maintenance and training.
5. Why is maintenance and training lacking? → Insufficient planning and accountability.

### **Step :6**

## **Wicked Problem Understanding**

This problem is classified as a **Wicked Problem** because:

- It involves multiple stakeholders (citizens, staff, administrators).
- Causes vary across regions and services.
- No single solution can fix all delays.
- Improving speed may affect verification and security.

### **Step :7**

#### **Reflection**

- This lab helped in understanding that government service delays are not caused by a single factor. Initially, it was assumed that delays were only due to staff inefficiency, but user feedback revealed deeper systemic issues such as corruption, technical failures, and lack of transparency.
- User perspectives highlighted the emotional stress caused by uncertainty and repeated visits. This exercise showed that jumping directly to solutions without understanding root causes can lead to ineffective outcomes.

#### **Conclusion**

Delays in government service approvals are a serious public issue caused by systemic, technical, and administrative factors. Addressing these challenges requires better digital infrastructure, strict timelines, and improved accountability.